

MORE THAN PLATES (PATENT VS MARKETING) · SCRIPT A**The patent is not a license plate reader**

About 2.7 min at ~140 words/min · 376 words · Replace [Your Name]. Speak calmly. One speaker, one focus.

Tip: swap bracketed fields. Cite numbers carefully. End with the cancel / yearly-vote ask.

Mayor Crawford, members of City Council. My name is [Your Name], and I live in Crossville.

Flock sells these cameras as license plate readers. The product, and the company's own patent, go much further than plates.

U.S. Patent US11416545B1 is assigned to Flock Group Inc. The inventors include CEO Garrett Langley. It was granted August 16, 2022. The title is not "license plate reader." It is a system for object-based query of video across a dynamic surveillance network.

Read what Flock told the Patent Office in the detailed description. The system classifies objects with neural networks. Vehicles are one class. People are another. For people, the specification describes classifying "male, female, race, etc.," clothing types, and estimated height and weight. A worked example says investigators may obtain "face recognition data points" from one camera and query other cameras for matching face recognition data points. That is cross-camera person matching language, not a plate scan.

Meanwhile Flock's public pages tell cities LPR products "do not use facial recognition" and "do not identify race, gender, or ethnicity." FreeForm is marketed as natural-language search "without facial recognition," while still advertising people-by-clothing queries like "man in blue shirt." Condor cameras are sold as live video units that detect and follow people. Vehicle Fingerprint markets make, model, color, and markings when a plate is missing.

A patent is not a product brochure. It does not prove every embodiment is live on Crossville's poles today. It does prove what Flock claimed as protectable IP, and what cities should demand in writing before renewal. Has anyone on this body read US11416545B1? Which people-search, demographic, and face-related features are contractually enabled versus disabled? Can Flock push software upgrades without a new council vote?

Do not buy the "just plates" pitch. Ask for the feature list in writing, then cancel until Crossville gets answers residents can check.

THE ASK (say this)

My ask is clear. Cancel Crossville's Flock contract and remove the cameras. Require a public hearing and a recorded City Council vote before any surveillance equipment is ever proposed again. If you will not cancel yet, take a recorded yes-or-no vote each year before any renewal, with no automatic renewal that skips a public vote, and publish monthly use reports the public can check. Thank you. I yield.

U.S. Patent

Aug. 16, 2022

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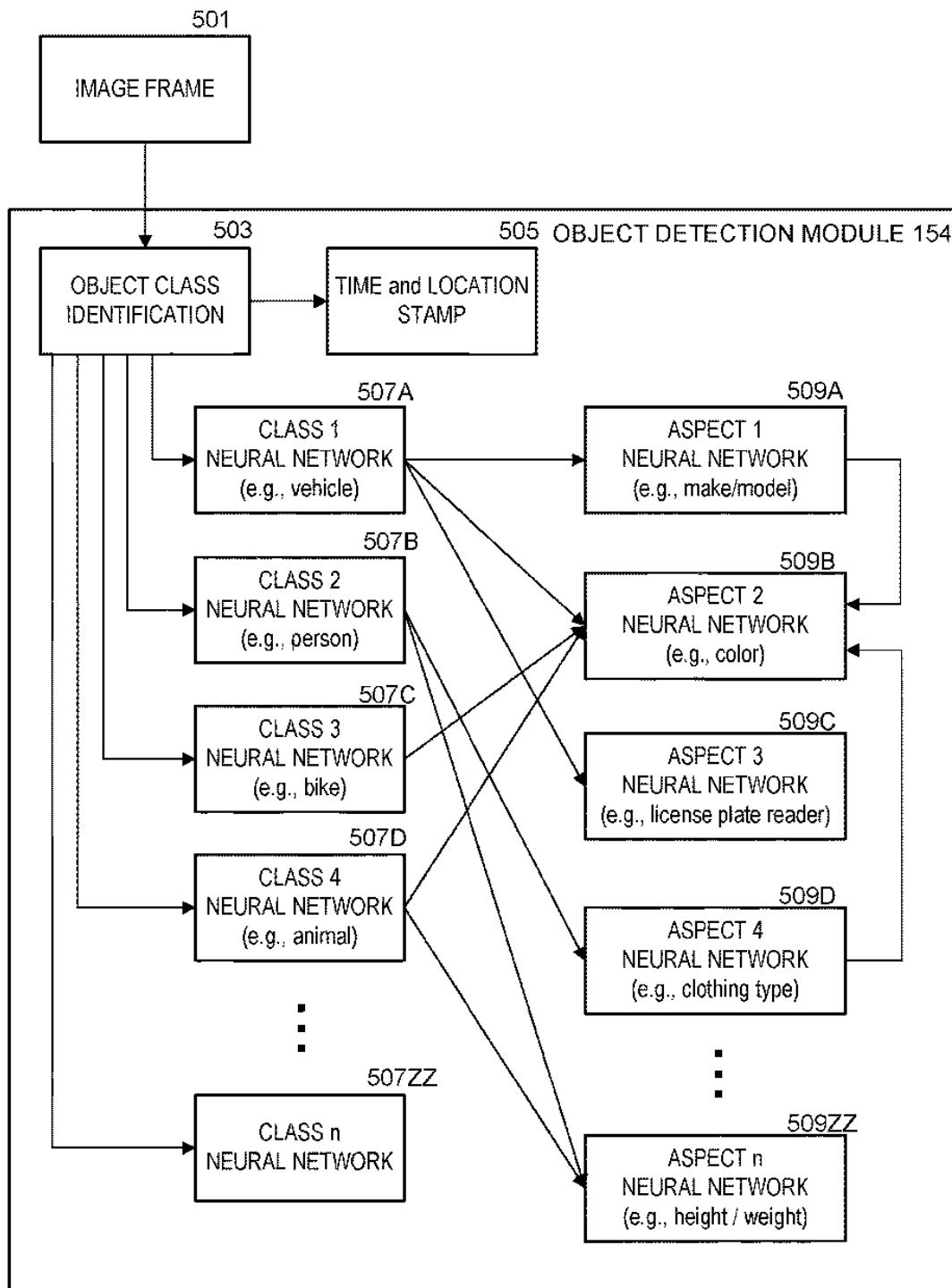


FIG. 5A

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Also, a nearby traffic light intersection outside the geographic footprint of the neighborhood 10 includes a traffic monitoring camera TMC-1 that captures video of any and all vehicles that pass through the intersection, including a picture of the associated license plates (the traffic monitoring camera forms its own component network within the dynamic surveillance network). And, nearby convenience stores outside the geographic footprint of the neighborhood 10 use commercial security systems CSS-1, CSS-2 with video surveillance devices (each commercial security system forming its own component network within the dynamic surveillance network).

A pedestrian with a portable recording device PRD-1 frequently walks through neighborhood 10. All of the exemplary surveillance devices CSS-1, CSS-2, HSS-1, HSS-2, NSD-1 through NSD-8, PRD-1 and TMC-1 are configured to record video and, optionally, upload the recorded footage to an embodiment of a dynamic surveillance and object-based query ("DSOQ") system according to the solution. Further, depending on a particular embodiment, exemplary surveillance devices may upload recorded footage for a first time based on an "opt-in" permission and, subsequently, upload recorded footage at a request or command of the DSOQ embodiment. In this way, embodiments of the solution may avoid upload and management of irrelevant or unneeded video footage at the DSOQ.

FIG. 1A represents activity in the neighborhood 10 at time window "n." During time window "n," a red car #1 entered neighborhood 10 between Block 5 and Block 8, drove straight through, and exited neighborhood 10 between Block 4 and Block 7. During the same time window "n," a blue car #1 entered the geographic footprint of neighborhood 10 between Block 1 and Block 4, turned left between Block 4 and Block 5, drove straight through, and exited neighborhood 10 between Block 7 and Block 8.

Red car #1 was captured as video content by TMC-1, NSD-4, PRD-1, and NSD-3. Similarly, blue car #1 was captured as video content by NSD-1, NSD-5 and NSD-7. Notably, the pedestrian manning PRD-1 didn't video blue car #1 due to recognizing the car and its driver as a local resident. By contrast, the pedestrian manning PRD-1 recorded video of red car #1, whether unintentionally while recording something else, or intentionally when noticing that the car was being driven slowly by a person the pedestrian didn't recognize.

FIG. 1B represents activity in neighborhood 10 at time window "n+1." During time window "n+1," a blue car #2 entered neighborhood 10 between Block 4 and Block 5, drove straight through, and exited neighborhood 10 between Block 7 and Block 8. Blue car #2 was captured as video content by surveillance devices CSS-1 (blue car #2 stopped for gas), NSD-5 and NSD-7.

FIG. 1C represents activity in neighborhood 10 at time window "n+2." During time window "n+2," red car #2 entered the geographic footprint of neighborhood 10 between Block 1 and Block 4, turned left between Block 4 and Block 5, drove straight through, and exited neighborhood 10 between Block 7 and Block 8. Red car #2 was captured as video content by NSD-1, NSD-5 and NSD-7.

Also during time window "n+2," red car #1 makes a second appearance in neighborhood 10. Red car #1 enters neighborhood 10 between Block 4 and Block 5, turned right between Block 5 and Block 8, turned right again between Block 5 and Block 6, then exited the geographic footprint of neighborhood 10 by turning left between Block 5 and Block 6. Red car #1 was captured as video content during time

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window "n+2" by CSS-1 (driver of red car #1 filled up red car #1 with gas and bought a candy bar). NSD-1, NSD-4 and TMC-1.

Referring to each and all of FIGS. 1A-1C, which illustrate different time windows and a dynamic geographic footprint relevant to a burglar investigation at house X, video content relevant to the burglar investigation may have been captured by any one or more of the various surveillance devices of the various component networks. As previously noted, investigators relying on the prior art would have to independently seek out and watch footage from each surveillance device of each component network over a given window of time—no piece of footage could go unwatched lest a relevant content be missed. In this way, users of the prior art may spend significant amounts of time identifying video sources and watching footage in an effort to identify relevant content. Advantageously, and as will become more apparent from the illustrations and description that follows, embodiments of a DSOQ system may aggregate video footage collected from multiple independent component network sources, analyze the footage, and store the footage based on the results of the analysis so that the footage may be queried in view of content and not just time/location.

Returning to the application scenario illustrated by FIGS. 1A-1C, investigators of the burglary event may put out a public notice seeking any information that may be relevant to the burglary. In response, the pedestrian associated with PRD-1 in FIG. 1A may let investigators know that she had recently witnessed an out of place car in neighborhood 10. Subsequently, an upload to the DSOQ system of the video taken on PRD-1 during time window "n" of red car #1 would get analyzed such that the red car #1 is identified as to make and color.

Focusing on the red car #1 "lead," the investigators may leverage the DSOQ system to return any footage captured by any of the NSD cameras of the neighborhood watch system that contains red car #1, dating back to the time stamp of the video captured by PRD-1. The DSOQ system may then return footage captured by NSD-4 and NSD-3 during time window "n" as well as footage captured by NSD-1 and NSD-4 during time window "n+2." Notably, and advantageously, the investigators could rule out any footage captured during time window "n+1" as no red car was identified by the DSOQ system in any content associated with video footage taken during that window. Further, depending on the statistical confidence of the object detection for footage taken during time window "n+2," video footage containing red car #2 may also be ruled out for viewing.

Using information from viewing of all footage with red car #1, the investigators may be able to narrow the time window during which red car #1 was in or around neighborhood 10. Dynamically increasing the zone of interest to other component networks within the dynamic surveillance network and expanding the query for video footage with content having a red car, the investigators may leverage the DSOQ system to identify video footage taken by CSS-2 when the driver of red car #1 purchased gas and a candy bar.

Advantageously, because the footage from CSS-2 may be queried and returned by the DSOQ system based on having the red car #1, investigators may avoid watching untold hours of irrelevant footage captured by CSS-2. With the relevant footage returned from CSS-2, the investigators may be able to identify the face of the driver of red car #1 when he purchased the candy bar. Now, with face recognition data points, the investigators may be able to query the DSOQ system for any footage captured by HSS-1 or HSS-2 having a person with matching face recognition data points. In this